

English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices, Grade 11

University Preparation (NBE3U)

College Preparation (NBE3C)

Workplace Preparation (NBE3E)

OVERVIEW

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” is designed as an alternative to the Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum. The English curriculum is based on the belief that language learning is essential to responsible and productive citizenship, and that all students can become successful language learners. The curriculum is designed to provide students with the knowledge and skills that they need to achieve this goal. The program helps students develop a range of essential skills in the four interrelated areas of oral communication, reading and literature studies, writing, and media studies, built on a solid foundation of knowledge of the conventions of standard English and incorporating the use of analytical, critical, and metacognitive thinking skills. Students learn best when they are encouraged to consciously monitor their thinking as they learn, and these courses include expectations that call for such reflection.

“English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” focuses on these core competencies through exploration of text forms emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, and also of the perspectives and influence of texts that relate to those cultures. The knowledge and skills described in the expectations will enable students to understand, respond to, and appreciate a full range of literary, informational, graphic, oral, media, and cultural texts and to create their own texts in a variety of forms.

Cultural text forms such as clothing and regalia, stories, songs, music, dances, and cultural practices embody social and cultural meanings in relation to their use in contemporary and historical contexts. Exploration of these text forms is therefore a crucial component of “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. It is critically important that students are taught to engage responsibly with these text forms, as well to follow appropriate cultural protocols to ensure respect for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. These protocols vary from nation to nation.

STRANDS

The Grade 11 compulsory courses of the English curriculum are organized in four strands, or broad areas of learning: Oral Communication, Reading and Literature Studies, Writing, and Media Studies. In “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices” these four strands are preceded by strand A: First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada. Although strand A is presented separately from the areas of learning presented in strands B–E, in practice students constantly apply the knowledge and approaches included in strand A as they work to achieve the expectations in all areas of learning.

The knowledge and skills described in strands B–E are interdependent and complementary. Teachers plan activities that blend expectations from the strands in order to provide students with the kinds of experiences that promote meaningful learning and that help them recognize how literacy skills in the four areas reinforce and strengthen one another.

A. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Perspectives and Text Forms in Canada

Identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, and self-governance are key concepts in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. As students explore texts emerging from and/or related to diverse Indigenous cultures, they learn to identify and analyse these concepts, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas. Through reading, listening, discussing, and writing about text forms in Canada, students also deepen their understanding of how textual representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women.

It is critically important that students learn to appreciate the responsibility that the creators of text forms in Canada have to affirm and acknowledge First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, world views, and diversity through authentic and complete representations of Indigenous lives.

B. Oral Communication

Oral language is a fundamental means of communication with others and the cornerstone of learning in all areas. Through talk, students not only communicate information but also explore and come to understand ideas and concepts; identify and solve problems; organize their experience and knowledge; and express and clarify their thoughts, feelings, and opinions. When they converse about information and ideas, they become aware not only of the various perspectives of other speakers and writers but also of the language structures and conventions they use. As students work towards achieving the expectations for this strand, they will improve their ability to explore and communicate ideas in both classroom and formal speaking situations.

To develop their oral communication skills, students need numerous opportunities to listen and to talk about a range of subjects, including personal interests, cultural knowledge, school work, and current affairs. Students should be provided with opportunities to engage in various thought-provoking oral activities in connection with expectations in all the strands – for example, brainstorming to identify what they know about the topic of a new text they are about to read, discussing strategies for solving a problem in a writing

assignment, presenting and defending ideas or debating issues, and offering informal critiques of work produced by their peers.

As students explore various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, they learn how to select and use culturally appropriate listening practices to further their understanding of the lessons and knowledge to be gained from traditional stories, including historical knowledge. They also gain insight into the social, economic, and political forces that affect the transmission of stories, as well as the significance of these stories not only to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities but also to Canadian society as a whole.

It is important for students to develop an understanding that some knowledge is sacred and may be shared only with permission and/or in certain situations. As a result, recording or reproducing an oral teaching, a story, or a song may require explicit permission from the knowledge holder and/or community.

Listening and speaking are essential skills for social interaction at home, at school, and in the community. In order for all students to benefit from the opportunities provided in the classroom for listening and speaking, differences in the norms and conventions associated with oral communication in different cultures must be taken into account. In addition, for some students, the notion that learning involves talk is unfamiliar, and talk that supports learning must be explicitly taught and modelled. All students can benefit from opportunities to improve their listening and response skills and to refine their ideas and their ability to express them.

The Oral Communication strand focuses on the identification and development of the skills and strategies effective listeners and speakers use to understand and interact with others. It also emphasizes the use of higher-order thinking skills to stimulate students' interest and engage them in their own learning.

C. Reading and Literature Studies

"English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices" focuses on developing the knowledge and skills that will enable students to become effective readers. An effective reader is one who not only grasps the ideas communicated in a text but is able to apply them in new contexts. To do this, the reader must be able to think clearly, creatively, and critically about the ideas and information encountered in texts in order to understand, analyse, and absorb them and to recognize their relevance in other contexts. Students can develop the skills necessary to become effective readers by applying a range of comprehension strategies as they read and by reading a wide variety of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources. It is also important that they read a range of materials that illustrate the many uses of writing. By reading widely, students will develop a richer vocabulary and become more attuned to the conventions of written language. Reading various kinds of texts in all areas of the curriculum will also help students to discover what interests them most and to pursue and develop their interests and abilities.

Reading is a complex process that involves the application of various strategies before, during, and after reading. For example, before reading, students might prepare by identifying the purpose of the reading activity and by activating their prior knowledge about the topic of the text. Teachers help build the necessary background knowledge for students

whose life experiences may not have provided them with the information they need to understand the text. During reading, students may use “cueing systems” – that is, clues from context or from their understanding of language structures and/or letter-sound relationships – to help them solve unfamiliar words, and comprehension strategies to help them make meaning of the text. Comprehension strategies include predicting, visualizing, questioning, drawing inferences, identifying main ideas, summarizing, and monitoring and revising comprehension. After reading, students may analyse, synthesize, make connections, evaluate, and use other critical and creative thinking skills to achieve a deeper understanding of the material they have read. It is essential that teachers provide adequate time for students to apply various strategies before, during, and after reading not only in order to develop reading skills but also to ensure that there is an opportunity to support students who may find some texts emotionally difficult due to their own experiences and connections to the material.

Teachers must use their professional judgement in deciding which comprehension strategies to model and teach, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms and on the nature of the particular texts students are reading.

Fluent, independent readers read frequently for a variety of different purposes – to locate information, to satisfy curiosity, for enjoyment, to build vocabulary, for research, and for various more specifically defined purposes. The purpose for reading will be determined by the teacher in some cases and by the student in others. The reading program should include a wide variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts that engage students’ interest and imagination – for example, novels; poetry; short stories; textbooks and books on topics in science, history, mathematics, geography, and other subjects; biographies, autobiographies, memoirs, and journals; plays and radio, film, or television scripts; encyclopaedia entries; graphs, charts, and diagrams in textbooks or magazines; instructions and manuals; graphic novels, comic books, and cartoons; newspaper and magazine articles and editorials; databases and websites; and essays and reports. Teachers should routinely provide materials that reflect the diversity of Indigenous peoples. Frequent exposure to good writing will inspire students to work towards high standards in their own writing and will help them develop an appreciation for the power and beauty of the written word.

This strand helps students learn to read with understanding, to read critically, to become familiar with various text forms and their characteristic elements, and to recognize the function and effects of various text features and stylistic devices. It helps students understand that reading is a process of constructing meaning and equips them with the strategies that good readers use to understand and appreciate what they read.

D. Writing

A central goal of the Writing strand is to promote students’ growth as confident writers and researchers who can communicate competently using a range of forms and styles to suit specific purposes and audiences and correctly applying the conventions of language – grammar, usage, spelling, and punctuation. These conventions are best learned in the context of meaningful and creative writing activities that allow students to develop the ability to think and write clearly and effectively on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

Writing, from initial musings to final publication, is a complex process that involves a range of complementary thinking and composing skills, as well as other language processes,

including reading, speaking, and listening. As writers compose, they consider their audience; make decisions about form, style, and organization; and apply their knowledge of language use. To develop these competencies, students need a supportive classroom environment, with opportunities to extend and refine their skills in using the writing process and doing research. Students need opportunities to apply these skills and to write daily, in many forms and genres, for a variety of purposes and audiences, and within different time constraints. The forms and genres explored may include essays, reports, short stories, poetry, scripts, journals, letters, biographies, children's stories, articles, blog posts, reviews, précis, explanations, instructions, notes, procedures, and advertisements. Because post-secondary institutions and employers require clear, well-organized writing, on demand and within strict timelines, students also need to learn and practise strategies for writing effectively and correctly in the context of in-class writing assignments and test situations.

Students benefit from opportunities to produce writing that is interesting and original and that reflects their capacity for independent critical thought on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures. Writing activities that students find meaningful and that challenge them to think creatively about topics and concerns that interest them will lead to a fuller and more lasting command of the essential skills of writing.

Writing on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures needs to be approached sensitively. Students learn to take into account the responsibility to ensure that their work is free from bias, stereotypes, misinformation, and cultural appropriation.

The overall expectations in this strand focus on the elements of effective writing (ideas/content, organization, voice, word choice, sentence fluency, language conventions, and presentation) and on the stages of the recursive writing process (planning for writing, drafting, revising, editing and proofreading, and publishing). In the specific expectations, the examples and sample questions refer to writing forms and language conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. The forms and conventions noted are not, however, the only ones that may be taught in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

E. Media Studies

The Media Studies strand focuses on the art, meaning, and messaging of various forms of media texts emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources. Media texts can be understood to include any work, object, or event that communicates meaning to an audience. Most media texts use words, graphics, sounds, and/or images, in print, oral, visual, or electronic form, to communicate information and ideas to their audience. Whereas traditional English language study may be seen to focus primarily on the understanding of the word, media studies focuses on the construction of meaning through the combination of several media "languages" – images, sounds, graphics, and words.

Media studies explores the impact and influence of mass media and popular culture by examining texts such as films, songs, video games, action figures, advertisements, music advertising media, clothing, billboards, television and streaming content, magazines, newspapers, photographs, and websites. These texts abound in our electronic information age, and the messages they convey, both overt and implied, can have a significant influence on students' lives. For this reason, critical thinking as it applies to media products

and messages assumes a special significance. Understanding how media texts are constructed and why they are produced enables students to respond to them intelligently and responsibly. Students must be able to differentiate between fact and opinion; evaluate the credibility of sources; recognize bias; be attuned to discriminatory portrayals of individuals and groups, such as Indigenous peoples, religious or sexual minorities, people with disabilities, or seniors; and question depictions of violence and crime.

Students' repertoire of communication skills should include the ability to critically interpret the messages they receive through the various media and to use these media to communicate their own ideas effectively as well. Skills related to media such as the Internet, film, and television are particularly important because of the power and pervasive influence these media wield in our lives and in society. Becoming conversant with these and other media can greatly expand the range of information sources available to students, and enhance potential career opportunities in the communication and entertainment industries.

To develop their media literacy skills, students should have opportunities to view, analyse, and discuss a wide variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit sources, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources and relate them to their own experience and/or understanding. They should also have opportunities to use available technologies to create media texts of different types (e.g., computer graphics, cartoons, graphic designs and layouts, podcasts, short videos, blogs, web pages).

This strand focuses on helping students develop the skills required to understand, create, and critically interpret media texts. It examines how images (both moving and still), sound, and words are used, independently and in combination, to create meaning. It explores the use and significance of particular conventions and techniques in the media and considers the roles of the viewer and the producer in constructing meaning in media texts. Students apply the knowledge and skills gained through analysis of media texts as they create their own texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

In the specific expectations in this strand, the examples and sample questions refer to media forms and conventions that are appropriate for instruction in the given course. These are not, however, the only forms and conventions that students may explore in the course. Teachers will continue to use their professional judgement to decide on the forms and conventions students will study, based on the identified learning needs of the students in their classrooms.

THE RESEARCH AND INQUIRY PROCESS

Educators are encouraged to refer to the general discussion of the research and inquiry process that appears in the introduction to this document (see page 24) for necessary information relating to all First Nations, Métis, and Inuit studies courses. Inquiry and research are at the heart of learning in “English: Understanding Contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices”. They are incorporated into all the strands as students locate, question, and validate information through a rigorous process of interpretation and reflection in oral communication, reading, writing, and media studies. Students develop their ability to ask questions more deeply or thoughtfully and to explore a variety of possible answers to those questions.

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Workplace Preparation

NBE3E

This course explores themes, forms, and stylistic elements of literary, informational, graphic, oral, cultural, and media texts emerging from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in Canada, as well as some texts that relate to those cultures. In order to better understand contemporary texts, students will explore connections between traditional and contemporary text forms and cultural and community aspects of identity, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance. Students will also create oral, written, and media texts focusing on the development of literacy, communication, and critical thinking skills necessary for success in the workplace and daily life. The course is intended to prepare students for the compulsory Grade 12 English workplace preparation course.

Prerequisite: English, Grade 10, Academic or Applied, or the Grade 10 locally developed compulsory credit (LDCC) course in English

A. FIRST NATIONS, MÉTIS, AND INUIT PERSPECTIVES AND TEXT FORMS IN CANADA

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

Throughout this course, students will:

- A1. Exploring:** explore themes related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in text forms created in Canada, formulating questions and comparing perspectives to stimulate a well-reasoned exchange of ideas about these topics;
- A2. Deconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of how representations of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals, communities, and cultures in text forms created in Canada are influenced by perspectives related to or shaped by historical period, cultural background, and social and political conditions and events, including perspectives related to gender and the role of women;
- A3. Reconstructing:** demonstrate an understanding of the role of contemporary and historical text forms created in Canada in representing the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, cultures, and world views, and assess the impact on Canadian society of efforts to challenge colonialist views and incomplete or inaccurate representations.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

A1. Exploring

Throughout this course, students will:

Identifying Text Forms

- A1.1** identify various cultural text forms* and associated customs from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain how they support the communication of meaning within the society (e.g., *Métis medallions and clothing communicate kinship ties through colour and ornamentation; the song sung by Anishinaabe/Ojibwe women water keepers communicates their sacred responsibility to heal Mother Earth and take care of the water supply*)

Sample questions: “Why is a pipe considered a cultural text form in First Nations and Métis cultures? How does the role of pipe carrier communicate meaning in relation to the pipe?”

What similar cultural text form and associated role can you identify in contemporary non-Indigenous society? What do such roles imply about a culture’s beliefs and values?”

Formulating Questions

- A1.2** formulate questions to guide their explorations of themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., factual question: “What does ‘non-status’ mean?”; comparative question: “What are some similarities between *Sedna* in Inuit creation stories and *Kumugwe* in Kwakwaka’wakw creation stories?”; causal question: “What are some consequences of *Coyote’s* trickery for other characters in the story?”)

* The term “cultural text form” is used in this document to refer to forms and means of communication – including, for example, elements of material culture, such as clothing and regalia; stories; songs, music, dances; and cultural practices – that have developed over time on the basis of the beliefs and values of the culture and that are respected, honoured, and passed on from generation to generation to express and communicate those shared beliefs and values. These forms employ various symbols, practices, images, sounds, and/or concrete forms to convey information and ideas. See [page 188](#) for background information and a chart identifying various types of cultural text forms.

Sample question: “What questions might help you understand the meaning of the cultural text forms that are present at a local First Nations, Métis, or Inuit gathering?”

Exploring Identities

A1.3 identify and describe some themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., *with reference to spiritual beliefs, cultural identities, self-identification and legal identification in Canada, feelings of loss and marginalization*)

Sample questions: “How does the main character of the story self-identify culturally?” “How does the residential school survivor in this narrative reveal feelings of loss? What are the survivor and the survivor’s family doing to relearn their culture?”

Exploring Relationships

A1.4 identify and describe some themes, ideas, and issues associated with relationships in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., *with reference to family ties, the continuance of traditional practices in urban settings to honour and renew a relationship with the spirit, the relationship between community goals and community-based educational programming and/or workplace training*)

Sample questions: “In this story, the main character refers to friends of his mother as aunties. How does this reflect his world view about family and community?” “In these oral texts, what is the significance of Mother Earth? What is the relationship of Mother Earth to Father Sky, Grandfather Sun, and Grandmother Moon?”

Exploring Self-Determination, Sovereignty, and Self-Governance

A1.5 identify and describe some themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in relevant non-Indigenous texts (e.g., *with reference to border crossing and citizenship, status and non-status legal classifications for members of First Nations communities; economic activity and sustainability*)

Sample question: “What types of cultural text forms are traditionally associated with expressions of sovereignty or self-governance?”

Comparing Perspectives

A1.6 compare a few perspectives on themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities, relationships, and self-determination, sovereignty, or self-governance, as reflected in various texts from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources (e.g., *compare the perspectives on the role of the extended family presented in a text by an Inuk author and one by a non-Indigenous author; after reviewing two or more texts, define success and well-being from a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspective and identify some similarities and differences with a non-Indigenous perspective*)

A2. Deconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Viewpoint

A2.1 determine how the messages relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures conveyed in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and, as appropriate, in non-Indigenous texts, might change if they were presented from a different perspective (e.g., *the perspective of a contemporary Métis woman who is attempting to reclaim her culture, of an Indigenous woman who has gone missing*), and suggest some historical, socio-political, or cultural factors, including factors related to gender and/or sexual orientation, that are shaping the viewpoint of the creator/author

Sample questions: “Why do you think the reporter chose to present the perspective of a property developer in this article about a proposal to build on land within the traditional territory of a First Nation? How might the article have changed if it had included quotations from First Nation community members?” “From whose perspective does the Ontario barn quilt project present the roles of First Nations women during the War of 1812? Whose voices does the project include? How might the message have been different if the quilts had represented the vision of an individual artist rather than a community-based project?”

Contradictions

A2.2 identify contradictions in how First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures have been depicted in various contemporary and historical Indigenous text forms, and non-Indigenous texts (e.g., *“unsophisticated” versus wise and spiritual beings, political activists versus passive targets of government policy*), and suggest some reasons for the divergence of views

Sample question: “In some European historical accounts of encounters between First Nations peoples and European settlers, First Nations individuals are depicted as naïve and unsophisticated, and in other accounts as wise and spiritual. How do you explain this contradiction?”

Positioning

A2.3 make inferences about attitudes towards First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content in various contemporary and historical text forms, providing evidence to support their opinions (e.g., *the volume of print and broadcast news coverage of the environmental degradation of traditional territories compared to the attention given to other environmental problems*)

Sample questions: “How might the daily inclusion of First Nations, Métis, or Inuit news items in a prominent regional news program affect the audience’s perceptions of the importance of the Indigenous community within the region? What factors should the news programmer take into consideration when selecting which stories to broadcast?”

Accessibility

A2.4 describe some contemporary and historical factors affecting public access to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *the availability of training on how First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural text forms can be respectfully and appropriately used in the workplace; the level of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit participation in the workforce; the development of digital content-sharing platforms*)

Sample question: “How do Métis communities in Ontario use digital content-sharing platforms to share cultural text forms containing traditional knowledge?”

Asymmetries

A2.5 identify some issues related to attempts to apply Western cultural criteria to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit text forms, including cultural text forms (e.g., *the undervaluation of the use of personal experience as a source of knowledge in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit oral texts*)

Sample questions: “Why do Indigenous knowledge holders often draw on personal experience as a source of authority when delivering oral texts? Why do you think Western audiences might misunderstand or undervalue the significance of that authority?”

A3. Reconstructing

Throughout this course, students will:

Acknowledging

A3.1 demonstrate an understanding of some challenges First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities face and have faced in controlling their own narratives and resisting colonialist views, as revealed in text forms studied in this course (e.g., *identify stereotypes of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals used in animated cartoons aimed at children*)

Sample question: “How does this particular stereotype in mainstream popular culture undermine authentic Inuit experience?”

Naming

A3.2 identify appropriate ways to refer to Indigenous peoples in several different contexts (e.g., *in community and workplace settings, in oral stories from or about different cultures*), and locate examples of inappropriate terminology in contemporary and historical text forms from both Indigenous and non-Indigenous sources

Sample questions: “What term should you use to describe the local First Nation community in your report on local economies?” “Why do you think the Aamjiwnaang First Nation changed its name from Sarnia Reserve? What does the new name convey?” “Why do you think the author of this text used a general term instead of identifying a specific First Nation? What is problematic about this form of naming?”

Diversity

A3.3 identify a few ways in which the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit lives, knowledge, cultures, and world views is represented or under-represented in contemporary and historical text forms (e.g., *locate an example of several distinct First Nations being depicted as a homogeneous group in a history textbook; identify the origins of diverse geographical place names in Canada to determine whether First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures are fully represented*)

Sample questions: “How does the textbook identify these First Nations? What is problematic about this representation?”

Relevance

A3.4 evaluate several different contemporary text forms to determine how accurately they represent the lives and activities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, past and present (*e.g., identify realistic and/or unrealistic elements in the portrayal of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk character in a television or online drama*), and describe some ways in which updated representations can influence society (*e.g., eliminating the use of stereotyped images such as tomahawks and war bonnets on sports team logos helps advance understanding of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit identities*)

Sample questions: “In what ways does the use of a First Nations symbol in this team logo perpetuate a stereotype?” “In your opinion, how might popular culture have shaped the ideas about Inuit individuals expressed by the author of this text? Why do you think so?”

Affirmation

A3.5 describe some contemporary efforts to affirm the value and counteract the undervaluation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural text forms (*e.g., as reflections of the cultural benefits that First Nations, Métis, and Inuit workers can contribute to workplace settings rather than evidence of a lack of assimilation into the mainstream work environment*)

Sample questions: “What opportunities and barriers can you identify with respect to the use of a talking circle to address workplace conflicts?” “How might an Indigenous community member who uses a sacred item such as a talking stone or an eagle feather when making a presentation to co-workers have a positive effect?” “When you see an inuksuk being used as a cultural symbol in non-Inuit contexts, how do you think it is being valued? How might this differ from the valuation of an inuksuk placed within the Arctic landscape?”

B. ORAL COMMUNICATION

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- B1. The Oral Tradition:** demonstrate an understanding of text forms, figures, and practices associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explaining how these traditions communicate meaning and how they are used in contemporary communities, and demonstrate the use of culturally appropriate listening practices;
- B2. Listening to Understand:** listen to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures in order to understand and respond appropriately in a variety of situations for a variety of purposes;
- B3. Speaking to Communicate:** use speaking skills and strategies appropriately to communicate with different audiences, for a variety of purposes, about themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as listeners and speakers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in oral communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

B1. The Oral Tradition

By the end of this course, students will:

Oral Text Forms and Their Use

- B1.1** identify various text forms associated with the oral traditions of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures; explain their purpose and symbolic meaning (*e.g., prayers and blessings are offered in thanks for the gifts of the natural world; acknowledgements verbalize the connections between the past, the present, and future generations of all human and other-than-human beings; petitions request spiritual guidance and/or intervention*); and describe a few customs governing their use (*e.g., recording oral teachings without explicit permission may be prohibited in order to protect traditional knowledge from misuse or appropriation; individual storytellers are selected from within clans, families, or a community to share and care for specific traditional stories*)

Sample questions: “How is oral storytelling viewed from a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit cultural perspective? How is this view different from or the same as a non-Indigenous view of oral storytelling roles and responsibilities?” “Why are specific storytellers chosen to care for

creation stories and their expression? How do storytellers ensure that traditional stories remain true to their original telling?” “Why do you think Elders, Métis Senators, knowledge holders, and/or storytellers in various traditional First Nations, Métis, and Inuit societies continue to respect the practice of sharing customs orally?”

Figures and Their Function

- B1.2** describe several different significant figures from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit oral stories (*e.g., Glooscap, Raven, Mother Earth, clan animals, Sky Woman, Grandfather Sun*), including their origins, roles, characteristics, and behaviour (*e.g., Grandmother Moon explains the cycle of life and nature through the Thirteen Moon Teachings; the clan animals of the Haudenosaunee Nation represent the earthly elements of land [deer, wolf, bear], water [turtle, beaver, eel], and sky [hawk, heron, snipe]*)

Sample questions: “How does the trickster interact with children? How does he interact with the natural environment?” “What role does Grandmother Moon play in Anishinaabe Ojibwe oral traditions? What ideas does her behaviour help convey about the role of women and parenting?”

Societal Influences

B1.3 describe the influence of several different social, economic, and/or political forces (e.g., the widespread availability of recording devices such as cell phone cameras, the transcription of previously exclusively oral stories, limited access to storytellers) on the disruption or continuation of oral traditions in contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities

Sample questions: “What are some specific ways in which First Nations, Métis, and Inuit families are keeping oral traditions alive today?” “What are some positive and negative effects of recording oral text forms in writing?”

Culturally Appropriate Listening Practices

B1.4 identify and use culturally appropriate listening practices during oral teachings by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit speakers (e.g., listen for extended lengths of time without interrupting or appearing impatient; generate mental images during a storyteller’s narration in order to be able to recall the story precisely)

Sample questions: “What are the elements of an ethical code of conduct for listening to a traditional teaching?” “How does visualizing key elements of an oral teaching as it is being told help you understand the events described and the time when they occurred?”

B2. Listening to Understand

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B2.1 identify the purpose of several different listening tasks, with a focus on listening to oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and set goals for specific tasks (e.g., to identify culturally specific terminology while listening to a presentation; to gather information on a topic of personal interest by conducting an interview)

Sample questions: “What kinds of information will you be listening for in this task? What might interfere with your ability to understand?” “How does your purpose in listening to Inuit throat singing differ from your purpose in listening to song lyrics? What do you hope to learn from each?”

Using Active Listening Strategies

B2.2 identify and use several different active listening strategies when interacting in a variety of communication contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., demonstrate an understanding of when to speak, when to listen, and how much to say; use body

language to indicate that they are listening attentively to a storyteller’s narration; ask a speaker to clarify an idea with an example)

Sample question: “How might you respectfully signal that you wish to ask an Elder or a presenter a question?”

Using Listening Comprehension Strategies

B2.3 identify and use several different listening comprehension strategies before, during, and after listening to understand both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., skim an article providing background information before a teacher read-aloud; use a summary chart to record a discussion; write down what they already know about a topic, including relevant vocabulary, before listening to a presentation)

Sample questions: “How might you prepare to listen to a presentation that is likely to include words that are unfamiliar to you? What strategies can you use to prevent the inclusion of such words from interfering with your ability to listen to or understand an Elder?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

B2.4 identify, in several different ways, important information and ideas in both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., identify terminology in a speaker’s presentation that is being used in a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit political context; list the key points of a chief’s address to the Assembly of First Nations; paraphrase a character’s speech from a dramatic reading)

Sample questions: “What specific terms did the Senator use in her speech to describe who the Métis people are?” “What insights into Inuit identity did the speaker offer?”

Interpreting Texts

B2.5 develop and explain interpretations of both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures using evidence from the text, including oral and visual cues, to support their interpretations appropriately (e.g., compare the experiences of learning a traditional dance by watching a live demonstration while listening to and following along with an instructor and by viewing an instructional video, and determine the strengths and weakness of each format; explain how the use of images or data affected their interpretation of a presentation about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit businesses)

Sample question: “How did the personal story that the speaker shared affect your interpretation of the main ideas being presented in the oral report?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

B2.6 extend their understanding of both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures by making connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (*e.g., listen to a classmate's presentation on the Sixties Scoop and then share their own thoughts about custodial care practices*)

Sample question: “How can you connect the ideas the speaker expressed about the state of Indigenous-language use in First Nations communities to your own experience of learning another language or your heritage language?”

Analysing Texts

B2.7 analyse both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, focusing on the ways in which they communicate information, themes, ideas, and issues and influence the listener's/viewer's response (*e.g., identify the specific techniques a presenter at a job fair uses to generate enthusiasm about employment opportunities for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth; explain how a speaker's use of an Indigenous protocol to open and close a presentation affected the audience*)

Sample questions: “How did the speaker create enthusiasm about the topic? What gestures did she use while speaking? What dynamic words did she repeat?” “How did the Elder's use of metaphor help you understand the message of the traditional teaching?”

Critical Literacy

B2.8 identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., describe the perspective expressed by an Inuk community leader in an interview about an environmental topic, identifying references to the natural world that reflect the leader's belief system; compare the use of stereotypes in two comedy routines to identify the beliefs and values of the performers*)

Sample questions: “In your opinion, does the gender of the speaker affect the audience's response to a speech about a controversial issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities? Why, or why not? What questions does this raise about identity and power?” “How do these comedians use stereotypes to appeal to their target audiences? How would the routines have to change to present fairer cultural representations?” “After listening to this interview with Inuit Elders, how would

you describe their perspective on climate change? What does this perspective reveal about Inuit culture and the beliefs and values of the Elders?”

Understanding Presentation Strategies

B2.9 explain how several different presentation strategies are used in oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures to inform, persuade, or entertain (*e.g., view videos of comedy routines to identify and compare the ways in which different comedians use body language to appeal to a specific audience; critique a mock job interview to identify effective and ineffective verbal and non-verbal communication*)

Sample questions: “What visual materials could have been used to support the presentation on cultural art forms? What effect might their inclusion have had?” “How could the presenters have observed cultural protocols more closely? How would that have improved the quality of the presentation?”

B3. Speaking to Communicate

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose

B3.1 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives for several different purposes, using language and following social codes appropriate for the intended purpose and audience (*e.g., introduce an Elder who is about to give an oral teaching, using culturally appropriate ways of naming; participate in a small-group discussion in order to reach consensus on a topic of importance to a local First Nation community; give specific and relevant examples about a recent field trip to inform fellow students who were not able to go*)

Sample question: “Why is it important to model the appropriate use of terminology when referring to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit themes or topics in an oral presentation to younger children?”

Interpersonal Speaking Strategies

B3.2 demonstrate an understanding of several different interpersonal speaking strategies, and adapt them appropriately to suit the purpose, situation, and audience, exhibiting sensitivity to cultural differences (*e.g., use humour to establish an inclusive tone in a presentation on a topic of concern; speak at appropriate points in a discussion, such as when another speaker pauses*)

Sample question: “How do you know when it is appropriate for you to speak during a work-related meeting?”

Clarity and Coherence

B3.3 orally communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives in a clear, coherent manner appropriate for the purpose, subject matter, and intended audience (*e.g., use age-appropriate language in an oral report intended for younger children about a specific First Nation, Métis, or Inuit culture*)

Sample question: “How can you incorporate a variety of examples to make your oral statements more effective?”

Diction and Devices

B3.4 use appropriate words, phrases, and terminology, and several different stylistic devices, to communicate information and ideas related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and/or perspectives and to engage their intended audience (*e.g., select specific words for a speaking task on a topic related to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit communities that acknowledge the cultural values of those communities; differentiate diction to explain the same task to a volunteer and to a community representative when preparing for a local community event*)

Sample question: “How does your word choice acknowledge the values held by your intended audience?”

Vocal Strategies

B3.5 identify several different vocal strategies and use them selectively and with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences (*e.g., project their voice to ensure their audience can hear; use an animated tone when reading aloud to children; use a tone that conveys authority when coordinating activities with peers*)

Sample question: “How can the contextual clues of audience, subject matter, and intention help you determine an appropriate volume for speaking?”

Non-Verbal Cues

B3.6 identify several different non-verbal cues and use them, with sensitivity to audience needs and cultural differences, to help convey their meaning (*e.g., identify a speaker's use of non-threatening and inclusive non-verbal cues to encourage participation at a dance demonstration, and use these cues in their own group discussions*)

Sample question: “What non-verbal cues from the community Elder helped you determine the types of communication that were appropriate to use in your responses?”

Audio-Visual Aids

B3.7 use several different audio-visual aids to support and enhance oral presentations on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and to engage their intended audience (*e.g., use video links in a seminar to provide visual context for key points they wish to make*)

Sample question: “How might adding a clip of an Indigenous journalist speaking about your topic support the facts you discuss in your presentation?”

B4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

B4.1 describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after listening to and speaking about texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, then explain which ones they found most helpful and identify several specific steps they can take to improve their oral communication skills (*e.g., describe how they adjust their questioning strategies in group discussions when they are particularly knowledgeable about the topic; plan to debate their topic with a critical friend before class presentations to improve their speaking skills*)

Sample questions: “What listening strategies do you use during a storytelling? Which ones do you find especially helpful, and why?” “What elements of public speaking do you find most challenging? What strategies might you use to improve in those areas?” “What specific speaking strategies encourage dialogue?”

Interconnected Skills

B4.2 identify several different skills they have in reading, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them interpret and discuss oral texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., describe how viewing television and online interviews can help them develop their ability to respond to questions in an interview for volunteer community service at a local Indigenous gathering or festival; identify how reading background material about First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit protocols helped them use culturally appropriate listening strategies during an oral teaching*)

Sample question: “How does your ability to locate and read informational texts help you address an honorary guest respectfully?”

C. READING AND LITERATURE STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- C1. Reading for Meaning:** read and demonstrate an understanding of a variety of literary, informational, and graphic texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, using a range of strategies to construct meaning;
- C2. Understanding Form and Style:** identify a variety of text forms, text features, and stylistic elements used in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and demonstrate an understanding of how they help communicate meaning;
- C3. Reading with Fluency:** use knowledge of words and cueing systems to read fluently;
- C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as readers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful before, during, and after reading texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature, and analyse the social and cultural influence of those contributions.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

C1. Reading for Meaning

By the end of this course, students will:

Variety of Texts

- C1.1** read several different short, student- and teacher-selected contemporary texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, identifying specific purposes for reading (e.g., *to find further information about a specific location cited in a textbook in order to understand its significance to First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit communities; to learn about a well-known First Nation, Métis, or Inuk individual by reading an online biography; to identify connections between traditional and contemporary clothing associated with a particular First Nation, as reflected in historical texts and contemporary fashion catalogues*)

Sample question: “What types of information do you hope to find in this biography?”

Using Reading Comprehension Strategies

- C1.2** select and use several different reading comprehension strategies before, during, and after reading to understand both simple and complex texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources (e.g., *visualize and sketch the characters in a short story, then use a mind map to represent and track their relationships; collaborate with a peer to identify key points in a newspaper article*)

Sample questions: “How did reading background material on the prevalent attitudes of settlers during the historical period help you understand this text?” “How does the character profile you prepared compare to that of your peers?”

Demonstrating Understanding of Content

- C1.3** identify important ideas and supporting details in both simple and complex texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources (e.g., *create a concept map illustrating the relationship between the characters and the land*)

delineated in a short story; compare the opinions on an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities expressed in two letters to the editor, using a Venn diagram)

Sample questions: “What is the main message of this media release? Which details support that message?”

Making Inferences

C1.4 make and explain inferences about both simple and complex texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, supporting their explanations with stated and implied ideas from the texts (*e.g., infer the general recommendations of the Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada: Calls to Action from the headings throughout the text; explain what the imagery in a poem implies about the natural world*)

Sample question: “How does the poet’s use of moon imagery affect the meaning of this poem?”

Extending Understanding of Texts

C1.5 extend their understanding of both simple and complex texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, by making connections between the ideas in them and in other texts and to their own knowledge, experience, and insights (*e.g., compare the challenges that conflicting world views pose for the protagonist of a short story with a similar challenge they have experienced personally*)

Sample questions: “How do the world views of the protagonist and antagonist conflict? What insights did you gain from this conflict that might lead you to act differently in a similar situation?”

Analysing Texts

C1.6 analyse both simple and complex texts in terms of the information, themes, ideas, and issues they explore in relation to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, identifying several different aspects of the texts that contribute to the presentation or development of these elements (*e.g., describe the main theme expressed in a song’s lyrics, identifying specific ways in which the message is reinforced; explain how the writer’s use of personal anecdote illuminates the theme of sovereignty or self-governance*)

Sample questions: “Why do you think the writer chose to repeat this particular phrase in the song’s lyrics? What effect does the repetition have on the development of the theme?” “How does the conflict between the characters reveal the theme of this story?” “What elements of the

play script help you understand that the events it describes are occurring in both the past and the present? How does this support the idea that human beings are connected to their ancestors?”

Evaluating Texts

C1.7 evaluate the effectiveness of both simple and complex texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, using evidence from the text to support their opinions (*e.g., evaluate the graphic elements of an informational website in terms of criteria such as currency and accuracy to determine how effectively they illustrate the lives of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals*)

Sample questions: “What omissions or misrepresentations has your research revealed in this biographical sketch of Pontiac? In what specific ways do they make it less effective?”

Critical Literacy

C1.8 identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex texts dealing with themes, ideas, and issues related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (*e.g., identify elements and/or omissions in a brochure outlining a company’s human resources policy that support or detract from the promotion of inclusivity and diversity; identify examples of gender bias or gender empowerment in a handbook on First Nations governance*)

Sample questions: “What information does this brochure leave out that potential employees of various cultural backgrounds might find important?” “What world view does this short story present?” “Why do you think this story is told from the point of view of a young Inuk girl? Could the same ideas be conveyed as convincingly by a narrator who is an Elder?”

C2. Understanding Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Text Forms

C2.1 identify several different characteristics of literary, informational, and graphic text forms, and explain how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view (*e.g., a campaign poster includes a candidate photograph, party logo, and slogan to communicate political affiliation and platform efficiently; a graphic novel uses images and typography to convey some types of information and ideas more concisely than a narrative novel can*)

Sample questions: “How is the teaching of the Covenant Chain reflected in the designs and colours of the beads in the Two Row Wampum?” “Why do you think political campaign posters usually include the candidate’s photograph and party affiliation? Why might these provide relevant information to First Nations, Métis, or Inuit voters?” “Why do you think some contemporary writers choose the graphic novel form to communicate First Nations, Métis, and Inuit world views to non-Indigenous readers?”

Text Features

C2.2 identify several different features of texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view (*e.g., describe how the layout of a graphic novel helps communicate the meaning of pivotal plot points; explain the function of sidebars in magazine articles; explain how visual elements such as colours and symbols support the message of a poster*)

Sample questions: “Why do you think this portion of the text is shaded?” “How does an index help you locate information?” “Which features of this website are designed to support the user’s navigation?” “What does the use of colour and symbolism on this poster advertising an Indigenous gathering communicate about the participating nations?”

Elements of Style

C2.3 identify several different elements of style in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources, and explain how they help communicate meaning or reflect a world view and enhance the effectiveness of the text (*e.g., describe how metaphors referring to the natural world enrich the poet’s expression of a world view; identify specific words and phrases used to convey the importance of the subject in a pamphlet about community health and wellness*)

Sample questions: “Does the animal metaphor used to describe the character in this story reveal personality traits you hadn’t considered before? Why, or why not? What do you associate with this animal? How does the metaphor connect the character to one of the story’s themes?”

C3. Reading with Fluency

By the end of this course, students will:

Reading Familiar Words

C3.1 demonstrate an automatic understanding of most words in several different reading contexts related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., read with understanding words from texts chosen for shared, guided, and independent reading and vocabulary in grade-level texts on topics of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals; correctly identify terminology associated with contracts, reports, and other workplace documents*)

Sample questions: “What are some familiar terms in this report? Where else have you seen this kind of terminology?”

Reading Unfamiliar Words

C3.2 use decoding strategies to read and understand unfamiliar words in texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant texts from non-Indigenous sources (*e.g., consult online resources that define First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural terms within contemporary contexts; find previous uses of the word in the text and try to grasp its meaning from the context; create a career-specific vocabulary list to consult when reading work-related texts*)

Sample questions: “Which nations described in this text are unfamiliar to you? How did you decode the descriptions? What words prompted you to rethink how individuals identify their First Nation affiliation?” “What strategy can you use to develop your knowledge of the names and histories of Inuit communities?”

Developing Vocabulary

C3.3 identify and use several different strategies to expand vocabulary (*e.g., make a list of new words encountered in texts they are reading in class; consult the websites of specific First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities to find the terms preferred by the particular community; identify familiar prefixes, suffixes, and root words in unfamiliar technical terminology*), focusing on words and phrases that have a particular significance for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities (*e.g., band, member, healing, Indian, reserve, residential school, smudge, status*)

Sample questions: “What does the term ‘status’ mean with respect to First Nations individuals? What is its significance for cultural identity?” “What is the difference between a ‘band’ and a ‘nation’?” “Why is it important to know that some words sound the same but are spelled differently?”

C4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

C4.1 describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after reading texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify several specific steps they can take to improve as readers (*e.g., record their use of various strategies to help them identify the ones they find most helpful; describe similarities and differences in the strategies they use to read a workplace incident report and a creation story*)

Sample questions: “What pre-reading strategy did you use before starting your independent reading of the report about community safety? Did it help you understand the report more clearly? Why, or why not?” “What effect did small-group discussions have on the predictions you made about the story? How was this strategy helpful?”

Interconnected Skills

C4.2 identify several different skills they have in listening, speaking, writing, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them read texts from and/or related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., describe how preparing written questions before reading informational texts can help them interpret key points; describe how listening to oral stories can help them understand written texts of the same stories*)

Sample question: “How did viewing a webcast about residential schools broaden your understanding of the character’s struggles in the short story?”

C5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Literature

By the end of this course, students will:

Development of Contemporary Literature

C5.1 identify the contributions of a few individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literature (*e.g., individuals: Ruby Slipperjack, Tomson Highway, David Bouchard, Alooook Ipellie; organizations: the Ontario Native Literacy Coalition RIEL Centre; the Canada Council for the Arts; initiatives: summer programs offered by district school boards, creative writing awards for Indigenous youth, the Indigenous Writers’ Gathering*)

Sample questions: “How does your local library promote First Nations, Métis, and Inuit authors, or books with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit content? What suggestions could you make to the library to support the development of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers?”

Influence of Contemporary Literature

C5.2 identify some ways in which contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit literary works contribute to identities and heritage in Canada and/or to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultural revitalization (*e.g., educating non-Indigenous individuals about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives; teaching children about their own cultural and linguistic heritage*)

Sample questions: “What influence have storybooks for children written about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures had on cultural revitalization in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities? What challenges do First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers face in producing these books?”

Influence of Technology

C5.3 identify some ways in which technology is being used to help promote the work of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers and publishers (*e.g., blogging offers a writing format and distribution channel that gives First Nations, Métis, and Inuit writers an opportunity to express their personal views publicly; social media platforms provide a large audience for readers to share their opinions of new literary work*)

D. WRITING

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- D1. Developing and Organizing Content:** generate, gather, and organize ideas and information to write for an intended purpose and audience on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style:** draft and revise their writing, using a variety of literary, informational, and graphic forms and stylistic elements appropriate for the purpose and audience;
- D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions:** use editing, proofreading, and publishing skills and strategies, and knowledge of language conventions, to correct errors, refine expression, and present their work effectively;
- D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as writers, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful at different stages of writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

D1. Developing and Organizing Content

By the end of this course, students will:

Identifying Topic, Purpose, and Audience

- D1.1** identify the topic, purpose, and audience for several different types of writing tasks on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (*e.g., a short narrative text describing the traditions of a particular First Nation, Métis, or Inuit group to inform a specific audience; an opinion piece about an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities for a school or community newsletter; a letter of application for a job in a workplace that focuses on Indigenous community issues*)

Sample questions: “Who is the audience for your narrative text? What do you think this audience will already know and what does it need to know about the cultural group whose traditions you are describing?”

Generating and Developing Ideas

- D1.2** generate and focus ideas for potential writing tasks, using several different strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (*e.g., ask themselves questions to identify their prior knowledge about the topic and the information they need to find; confer with peers to identify*

local First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals who may be helpful sources of information; consult social media sites to identify sources of current First Nations, Métis, and Inuit news that would help them broaden their understanding of an issue they wish to write about; record the sources they consult and the ideas and information they gather in a form that is easy to understand and retrieve, such as a T-chart)

Sample questions: “What writing ideas were generated in your group discussion? How did you focus these ideas to decide on a particular topic?”

Research

- D1.3** locate and select information to support ideas for writing, using several different strategies and print, electronic, and other resources, as appropriate (*e.g., identify several types of sources that are likely to provide relevant information for their assignment, such as newspaper articles, multimedia resources, or interviews with local Métis community leaders; use keyword searches when browsing the Internet to locate specific information relevant to their topic; compile a works cited list or list of references to record all sources of information, observing conventions for proper documentation; use a checklist to evaluate sources and information for reliability, objectivity, and comprehensiveness*)

Sample questions: “How have discussions with your peers and local First Nations, Métis, or Inuit community partners about your project helped you focus your writing on current, relevant, and engaging perspectives?” “What does ‘plagiarism’ mean? Why do you think people plagiarize? Why is it wrong?”

Organizing Ideas

D1.4 identify, sort, and order main ideas and supporting details for writing tasks, using several different strategies and organizational patterns suited to the content and the purpose for writing (e.g., *in small groups, cluster key ideas to develop an agenda for a meeting of the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit student advisory committee; use a graphic organizer such as a T-chart to list First Nations, Métis, and Inuit resources that the school library contains and does not contain, in preparation for writing a report recommending additional resources*)

Sample questions: “Who is it important to consult when you are developing your agenda? How did you determine the most important items for the agenda? What ‘talking points’ will you use to generate discussion for each agenda item?”

Reviewing Content

D1.5 determine whether the ideas and information gathered are relevant to the topic, sufficient for the purpose, and meet the requirements of the writing task (e.g., *re-read the information gathered to ensure that it does not present First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures as cultures of the past; review the information gathered from all sources to determine whether any important ideas are missing*)

Sample questions: “As you review the assignment details and the notes you have made for your report, how closely do they match? What further research could you do to minimize gaps?”

D2. Using Knowledge of Form and Style

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

D2.1 write for different purposes and audiences using several different literary, informational, and graphic text forms (e.g., *a poem on the theme of cultural identity, based on a model of a poem studied in class; a graphic chronology of the Mother Earth Water Walks around the Great Lakes to explain the initiative to elementary students; a letter to the editor offering a supported opinion about an Inuit community initiative; a memo to the school parent council summarizing the requests of the*

First Nations, Métis, and Inuit student advisory committee)

Sample questions: “You’ve been asked to write a human interest story for a lifestyle magazine. In what other text forms have you encountered human interest stories? Who do you think the audience is?” “In what ways does a news report differ from a magazine article?”

Voice

D2.2 establish an identifiable voice in their writing, modifying language and tone to suit the form, audience, and purpose for writing (e.g., *use vivid, descriptive language to establish a mood of urgency in a poem about an environmental issue; use a businesslike tone and an appropriate level of language in a letter to a provincial or territorial organization requesting youth representation in the organization*)

Sample questions: “How might you change the language of your memo to make the tone more businesslike and authoritative? What synonyms would sound more formal?”

Diction

D2.3 use appropriate descriptive and evocative words, phrases, and expressions to make their writing clear and vivid for their intended audience (e.g., *in an article for a community newsletter, respectfully incorporate words and phrases that emphasize a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit perspective in order to make a connection with their audience; describe the physical and emotional characteristics of an auntie, uncle, grandmother, grandfather, or Elder in some detail to convey personality; make a list of active verbs and vivid adjectives that evoke a character in a First Nation, Métis, or Inuit traditional story, and choose effective ones to use in a descriptive paragraph*)

Sample questions: “Where might you respectfully add words from the Inuktitut language to give your article greater impact?” “Does your description of an auntie, uncle, or Elder provide enough detail to allow your reader to visualize the person? If not, what words might you add?”

Sentence Craft and Fluency

D2.4 write complete sentences that communicate their meaning clearly and accurately, varying sentence type, structure, and length for different purposes and making logical transitions between ideas (e.g., *use transitional words to show the relationship between ideas in two or more sentences; combine short sentences where appropriate to clarify meaning*)

Sample questions: “Which transitional words do you use repeatedly? What other words might you use to make the relationship between your

ideas more obvious?” “Where in your text do you use many short sentences in a sequence? How might you combine some of them?”

Critical Literacy

D2.5 explain how their own beliefs, values, and experiences are revealed in their writing, and identify how a belief or value may either reflect or conflict with a First Nation, Métis, and Inuit world view (e.g., *identify how their description of an object or a place, as expressed in a short narrative, reveals their cultural values; in a personal essay, describe their response to cultural expectations they have encountered in their work experiences and explain the belief or value that shaped their response; identify the specific ways in which a journal entry about their personal experiences during a camping trip reflects or conflicts with a First Nation world view about the relationship between the people and the land*)

Sample questions: “How do you think the language you have chosen to use in this piece of writing reflects your values?” “Have you considered diverse points of view in your writing? If so, how have you acknowledged them? If not, how might you do so?” “Which character in your text most closely reflects your own perspective on the subject?”

Revision

D2.6 revise drafts to improve the content, organization, clarity, and style of their written work, using several different teacher-modelled strategies (e.g., *identify wording in their work that indicates gender bias and substitute gender-neutral language; reorganize the sentences in a piece of writing to improve the flow of ideas; determine whether the inclusion and/or repetition of a word or phrase would reinforce their argument and enhance the effectiveness of their text*)

Sample questions: “How might you vary the type and length of your sentences to make your writing more interesting for the reader?” “Does your writing tell your readers everything they need to know in order to understand your perspective? If not, what might you add?” “How has your revision made your text clearer?” “In your description of the Mother Earth Water Walks, how might you incorporate a reference to a cultural text form from a specific First Nation to make your topic more immediate?”

Producing Drafts

D2.7 produce revised drafts of both simple and complex texts written to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (e.g., *adequate development of information and ideas, logical*

organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions)

Sample question: “Before you submit your revised plan for promoting cultural awareness in your school community, check to ensure that you have not missed any steps. Could another person follow the steps you describe without difficulty?”

D3. Applying Knowledge of Conventions

By the end of this course, students will:

Spelling

D3.1 use knowledge of spelling rules and patterns, several different types of resources, and appropriate strategies to spell familiar and new words correctly (e.g., *apply spelling patterns, such as “i before e except after c”, appropriately; maintain a list of words learned from shared, guided, and independent reading texts to help them spell words correctly; check their spellings in print and electronic resources; apply their knowledge of root words, prefixes, and suffixes to spell technical words correctly*)

Sample questions: “When you used the spelling checker in your word-processing program, what errors did it reveal?” “What resources did you consult to find a spelling pattern?”

Vocabulary

D3.2 build vocabulary for writing by confirming word meaning(s) and reviewing word choice, using several different types of resources and strategies, as appropriate for the purpose (e.g., *create a list of new words they encounter in print and online texts, noting the context in which the words are used, to expand the vocabulary they use in their own texts; consult a classroom word wall to find synonyms; consult glossaries and technical dictionaries to confirm word meanings; compile a list of technical words encountered in trade publications and use them in their own writing*)

Sample question: “What other words or phrases could convey the meaning more clearly in this report?”

Punctuation

D3.3 use punctuation correctly to communicate their intended meaning (e.g., *use quotation marks to set off words and phrases taken from written and oral sources; use punctuation that is appropriate to the form of their writing, such as letters, memos, and notes*)

Sample questions: “Read your work aloud to the group, pausing where you have used

commas and periods. Where do you and your peers think punctuation is missing? Where do you think the punctuation is unnecessary?"

Grammar

D3.4 use grammar conventions correctly to communicate their meaning clearly (*e.g., write complete and correct simple, compound, complex, and compound-complex sentences; consistently make verbs agree with their subjects and pronouns agree with their antecedents*)

Sample questions: "Could you combine these short sentences to make a more interesting longer sentence? Which connecting words would you use? Does the punctuation need to be changed to make the sentence grammatical?"

Proofreading

D3.5 proofread and correct their writing, using guidelines developed with the teacher and peers (*e.g., review drafts using an editing checklist specific to the writing task; use a highlighter to mark potentially incorrect words or phrases in their draft, and then check appropriate resources to confirm correct spelling and/or usage*)

Sample questions: "What words did you highlight as possible errors when you re-read your text? Have you checked those words to confirm their meaning and their spelling?"

Publishing

D3.6 use several different presentation features, including print and script, fonts, graphics, and layout, to improve the clarity and coherence of their written work and to engage their audience (*e.g., select appropriate fonts and graphics and an appealing layout for a brochure, keeping their purpose and audience in mind; select appropriate images to illustrate a procedural text*)

Sample question: "How might you use the four directions model to visually support the message of your text?"

Producing Finished Works

D3.7 produce pieces of published work to meet criteria identified by the teacher, based on the curriculum expectations and respecting First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communication styles (*e.g., adequate development of information and ideas, logical organization, appropriate use of form and style, appropriate use of conventions*)

Sample questions: "What important points have you learned from creating a school handbook? What important considerations might you include on a checklist to guide others in producing a similar handbook, to ensure that the work reflects equity, inclusion, and diversity?"

D4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

D4.1 describe several different strategies they used before, during, and after writing texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify several specific steps they can take to improve as writers (*e.g., describe how working in a small group helped them or distracted them in generating ideas for writing; describe specific ways in which reading a piece of writing aloud to a partner for feedback helped them to improve it; identify a skill they need to strengthen and set a goal for improving that skill*)

Sample questions: "What specific problem did you encounter while working on this writing assignment, and how did you resolve it? What did that experience teach you about your preferred learning style?" "Reflecting on your approach to this writing task, what strategies for generating ideas will you use for future writing tasks?" "What would you do differently if you had the opportunity to redo this writing assignment?"

Interconnected Skills

D4.2 identify several different skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, viewing, and representing, and explain how these skills help them write on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures more effectively (*e.g., describe how listening to song lyrics by First Nations, Métis, and Inuit musicians enhanced their ability to write about an issue of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities*)

Sample question: "How did listening closely to Elders and Métis Senators help you write the dialogue for a scene about the Indian residential school system in Canada?"

Portfolio

D4.3 select examples of several different types of writing that they think most clearly reflect their growth and competence as writers, and explain the reasons for their choice (*e.g., select a piece of writing for a class anthology and explain why they think it is a good example of their work; choose several pieces for a literacy portfolio to reflect their growth as writers over time, explaining how each one demonstrates an improvement in their skills*)

Sample questions: "Which pieces of your writing best reflect your writing skills? Why are these pieces important to you?"

E. MEDIA STUDIES

OVERALL EXPECTATIONS

By the end of this course, students will:

- E1. Understanding Media Texts:** demonstrate an understanding of a variety of media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources;
- E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques:** identify some media forms and explain how the conventions and techniques associated with them are used to create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E3. Creating Media Texts:** create a variety of media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques;
- E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies:** reflect on and identify their strengths as interpreters and creators of media texts, areas for improvement, and the strategies they found most helpful in understanding and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures;
- E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media:** identify various contributions of individuals, organizations, and initiatives, including technological initiatives, to the development of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media production, analysing the social and cultural influence of those contributions and the role of media literacy.

SPECIFIC EXPECTATIONS

E1. Understanding Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

- E1.1** explain how both simple and complex media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, are created to suit particular purposes and audiences (*e.g., identify the audience for a blog written in the first person and expressing personal ideas and opinions on a variety of topics; explain the purpose of using on-location footage and interviews with eyewitnesses or experts in a documentary*)

Sample questions: “What does an audience expect the purpose of a documentary to be? How does a documentary convey authenticity and factual accuracy?”

Interpreting Messages

- E1.2** interpret both simple and complex media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media

texts from non-Indigenous sources, identifying and explaining the overt and implied messages they convey (*e.g., explain the implied message of a poster advertising a movie with a First Nations, Métis, or Inuit theme, identifying specific elements of the imagery or text that support their conclusions; identify key messages in a radio program about an environmental issue*)

Sample questions: “How did imagery play an important role in national news reports about the Oka Crisis in 1990? What were the overt and implied messages conveyed by the images included in reports of the stand-off? What effect did these images have on the audience?”

Evaluating Texts

- E1.3** evaluate how effectively information, themes, ideas, issues, and opinions are communicated in both simple and complex media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, and decide whether the texts achieve their intended purpose (*e.g., comment on the effectiveness of including authentic*

family and/or community photos and video clips to convey aspects of life in northern Ontario in a film about a particular First Nation community; determine whether the captions in a multimedia text about work opportunities for Métis youth provide all the necessary information)

Sample questions: “Would including First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals in their recruitment commercials be an effective way for banks to attract more diverse job applicants? Why, or why not? What might the banks need to consider in making such commercials?”

Audience Responses

E1.4 identify and explain different audience responses to selected media texts (e.g., suggest reasons why a musician might perform different versions of a particular song for different audiences; identify various possible responses to celebrity endorsements of animal protection laws relating to species in the Canadian North)

Sample question: “Why might you, people in your community, or members of an Indigenous community respond differently to a song about an environmental issue?”

Critical Literacy

E1.5 identify the perspectives and/or biases evident in both simple and complex media texts from First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and, as appropriate, relevant media texts from non-Indigenous sources, and comment on any questions they may raise about beliefs, values, identity, and power (e.g., identify the perspective of a movie poster advertising a film about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth; identify some typical aspects of portrayals of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals in product advertising and describe the impression created by these depictions)

Sample questions: “How realistic do you find the portrayal of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth on this poster? What reasons can you give for your opinion?” “Why do you think these museum brochures depict First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals in traditional clothing? What do you think is the intended and/or unintended effect on potential museum patrons?”

Production Perspectives

E1.6 describe several different production, marketing, and distribution factors that influence the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media industry (e.g., describe some factors that promote or restrict the participation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit producers/directors in the Canadian film industry; identify various social media outlets that promote the First Nations, Métis, and Inuit film industry)

Sample questions: “Where can youth find information on emerging First Nations, Métis, and Inuit film and video producers? Are these mainstream outlets, or outlets that target Indigenous audiences? Do you find them effective as a source of information? Why, or why not?”

E2. Understanding Media Forms, Conventions, and Techniques

By the end of this course, students will:

Form

E2.1 identify general characteristics of several different media forms and explain how they shape content and create meaning in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., regional First Nations, Métis, and Inuit newspapers include photographs of local individuals and events in their coverage to encourage a sense of community; radio dramas use sound effects to create mental pictures for listeners; music videos use editing techniques to present visual interpretations of songs by contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit musicians)

Sample questions: “What media form do you think best supports the need of a local First Nation organization to communicate about local events? What elements of the form make it conducive to this purpose?”

Conventions and Techniques

E2.2 identify several different conventions and/or techniques used in familiar media forms and explain how they convey meaning and influence their audience in the context of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., the inclusion of shots of the audience at videoed outdoor Indigenous gatherings encourages viewers to share the enjoyment; the use of cultural symbols and/or images on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit community organization websites emphasizes the cultural identities of the communities; framing, camera angle, lighting, and editing are techniques used in film-making to convey meaning and create mood)

Sample questions: “What conventions of script writing can support the expression of Indigenous spiritual themes? What techniques has the playwright used to convey the connections between the main character and ancestral spirit beings?” “What effect did the alternating use of close-ups and wide shots have in this movie about life in an Arctic community?”

E3. Creating Media Texts

By the end of this course, students will:

Purpose and Audience

E3.1 describe the topic, purpose, and audience for media texts they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., a poster inviting all students to a forum on issues of importance to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth in the school), and identify specific challenges they may face in achieving their purpose (e.g., determining how to represent diverse groups of people on a single poster while keeping the message clear; finding appropriate locations to post their invitation to the student forum)

Sample questions: “As you work on your poster, why might it be important to identify the locations where students usually seek information about school events? Who could you speak to about additional places to post an invitation to all students?”

Form

E3.2 select a media form to suit the topic, purpose, and audience for a media text they plan to create on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, and explain why it is an appropriate choice (e.g., explain why a welcome sign containing greetings in diverse Indigenous languages might be an effective way to promote student awareness of the diversity of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures)

Sample questions: “Why might a First Nations, Métis, and Inuit event page on the school website be an effective way to build awareness about resources and supports for all students and their families in the school community?”
“How might you promote an exhibition showcasing local First Nation art forms and artists? What media form would you choose?”

Conventions and Techniques

E3.3 identify several different conventions and/or techniques appropriate to a media form they plan to use, and explain how these will help communicate meaning (e.g., combining cultural motifs with an image of the urban landscape on a poster promoting a compilation of Métis music will emphasize the traditional roots and contemporary relevance of the songs; using music and typographic effects conventionally associated with horror films in a film trailer will heighten the audience’s expectation of frightening scenes)

Sample questions: “What features of the film-making software could you use to provoke a sense of horror or fear in your film trailer? What type of sound bites might you use? How might you use typography to capture the mood?”

Producing Media Texts

E3.4 produce media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, for several different purposes and audiences, using appropriate forms, conventions, and techniques (e.g., a webinar on First Nations, Métis, and Inuit diversity to explain the many nations represented by the student body; a public service announcement about on-reserve health and safety; packaging for a fashion line of T-shirts showcasing cultural symbols)

Sample questions: “What type of media display could you create to commemorate an important event in the local First Nation community? What elements would you include in your display to communicate the significance of the event?”

E4. Reflecting on Skills and Strategies

By the end of this course, students will:

Metacognition

E4.1 describe several different strategies they used in interpreting and creating media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, explain which ones they found most helpful, and identify several specific steps they can take to improve as media interpreters and producers (e.g., explain how identifying implicit messages in media texts helps them detect media manipulation in everyday situations; describe how creating several different mock-ups of a poster, rather than focusing their initial efforts on a single design, can develop their ability to communicate a specific message effectively; plan to use feedback to clarify the message of their media text and to enhance its appeal to their audience)

Sample questions: “What strategies did you use to detect contemporary First Nations, Métis, and/or Inuit voices in the news program? Would you use the same strategies again? Why, or why not?”

Interconnected Skills

E4.2 identify several different skills they have in listening, speaking, reading, and writing, and explain how these skills help them interpret and create media texts on subject matter related to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures (e.g., explain how listening attentively to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media producers being interviewed about their work can help them create online reviews of films and documentaries by those producers)

Sample question: “How does interviewing a member of an urban Indigenous community on a particular topic help you focus your ideas for a media production on the same issue?”

E5. First Nations, Métis, and Inuit Voices in Contemporary Media

By the end of this course, students will:

Media Development

E5.1 identify the contributions of a few individuals, organizations, and initiatives to the development and production of contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts (e.g., individuals: *Lisa Charleyboy, Zacharias Kunuk*; organizations: *the Aboriginal Multi-Media Society, the Inuit Broadcasting Corporation*; initiatives: *the imagineNATIVE Film + Media Arts Festival*)

Sample questions: “Which knowledge keepers can you name who have shared their teachings using contemporary media forms? Why might contemporary storytellers and traditional knowledge keepers choose to share their stories through media texts?”

Influence of Media Production

E5.2 identify some ways in which contemporary First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media texts contribute to identities and heritage in Canada (e.g., *educating non-Indigenous audiences about First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures and histories; including First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives in cultural production in Canada*) and act as a social and cultural force in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities (e.g., *encouraging the participation of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit youth in contemporary media careers*)

Sample question: “How might a video posting of a First Nation, Métis, or Inuk environmental leader sharing an Indigenous perspective on climate change act as a social force in a First Nation community?”

Media Literacy and Media Access

E5.3 identify several different initiatives to improve First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media literacy (e.g., *online educational resources, such as tutorials and interactive modules, that focus on media issues relating to First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and cultures*) and to expand First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media access (e.g., *the expansion of broadband systems to deliver public service to remote and rural First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities; government support for television broadcasters providing Indigenous content to facilitate the coverage of up-to-date news and political information*)

Sample questions: “What kinds of resources does the web centre MediaSmarts offer?” “How have social media increased the ability of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit media producers and creators to gain access to industry leaders and media talent?” “How might a TEDx event meet the need to share First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives and local knowledge?” “What is a virtual Indigenous community? What purposes does it serve?”

Appendix to the English Courses

CULTURAL TEXT FORMS

Cultural text forms serve an important purpose in First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, in that they are used to express and communicate a culture's beliefs and values. Their function and purpose distinguish them from purely artistic creations, though they often have aesthetic qualities as well. They may be elements of material culture, including tangible objects; stories; songs, music, or dances; or cultural practices, including those associated with food or medicines. Some examples of cultural text forms and their significance follow:

- traditional clothing, which often expresses the cultural, spiritual, social, and/or political identities of First Nations, Métis, and Inuit communities
- songs and music, including the practices of drum keepers and dancers (often delineated by gender), used to transmit Indigenous knowledge
- prayers, often expressing belief in the power of spirit to heal
- addresses, affirmations, and orations, illustrating the significance of spoken text
- fire lighting and the burning of sacred medicines to cleanse and purify and/or to communicate with spirit beings
- symbolism embodied in material life to reflect kinship ties, family histories, land agreements, business partnerships, spiritual life, and so on
- oral and written stories used to record and communicate stories of origin, family histories and histories of nations, and relationships to land, spirit, and creation
- languages themselves, which embody and reflect beliefs, values, and significant relationships between humankind and creation

Every culture has a distinct way of creating, passing on, using, and showing respect for its cultural text forms. Some cultural text forms are protected, according to Indigenous traditions. It is therefore critical for educators to understand that it may be necessary for them to engage with and seek direction from the specific Indigenous community from which a cultural text form originates before using it in a classroom setting.

Some cultural text forms, such as prayer, song, and music, are found across First Nations, Métis, and Inuit cultures, while others are unique to particular groups. The chart that follows provides examples of the cultural text forms used by particular cultural groups. It highlights some of the rich forms of communication among Indigenous societies of the oral tradition in Canada.

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Blackfeet	Winter counts	Pictorial calendars or histories drawn on buffalo hides, with a representation of a significant event for each year.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Anishinaabe Ojibwe	Water song	A song sung by women, as the water keepers, to show respect and reverence for the spirit of water, in recognition of its sacredness and its immense importance to all of creation.	To be listened to
Anishinaabe, Haudenosaunee, and other First Nations	Covenant Chain Belt of 1764	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells, beads, and string that records the agreement made at Niagara between the British and several First Nations.	To be viewed and read
Haudenosaunee	Thanksgiving address	Words spoken at the beginning of ceremonies and significant meetings to give thanks to the natural environment.	To be listened to
Haudenosaunee	Guswenta or Kaswentha (Two Row Wampum)	A wampum belt displaying symbols made from shells and string that records an agreement between the Haudenosaunee and the Dutch in the mid-seventeenth century. Each row represents a nation, with the belt showing the nations co-existing without interfering in each other's affairs.	To be viewed and read
Métis	Beaded clothing	Items of clothing decorated with detailed beadwork, often in distinctive floral designs. Colours and patterns may convey aspects of Métis history, Métis teachings, and/or family identity.	To be viewed

Cultural Group	Example of Cultural Text Form	Meaning/Purpose	Mode of Communication
Inuit/Inuvialuit	Drum dance	A combination of drumming and dance, traditionally performed by men. Drum dances may be used as a peaceful way to settle disputes.	To be listened to, viewed, and presented
Tsimshian	Button blanket	A robe decorated with white buttons forming images of an animal that represent the clan of the individual wearing the blanket.	To be viewed, read, and presented
Tsimshian	Dances such as the raven dance and the killer whale dance	Dances that communicate important stories about history and creation. Families and/or clans collect and protect these dances, which are passed from one generation to the next.	To be presented and viewed